

WOMEN'S AND GENDER STUDIES

Overview

The Women's and Gender Studies Program is a cross-disciplinary program in the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences. The program invites students to examine gender across time, place, culture, and academic disciplines. WGS courses provide students with an understanding of women's history, gender theories, and social structures. Students learn through research, discussion, and application that interrelated factors — e.g., race, ethnicity, class, age, disability, gender identity, religion, national origin, and sexual orientation — inform their understanding of women's history, culture, and social roles.

As a cross-disciplinary program, students take core courses in WGS and complete their major by choosing courses from areas that most interest them, including sociology, psychology, history, political science, English and communication, world languages, philosophy and religion, biology, art, and design. Students can tailor their coursework to the aspects of gender that fit their interests and career goals. Students acquire knowledge and skills relevant to careers in various fields, including social work, counseling, healthcare, nonprofit administration and advocacy, education, government, business, law, media, and the arts.

By gaining a strong foundation in gender theories, an understanding of human experiences and social structures, and the ability to apply their knowledge in the real world, WGS graduates are well-prepared to contribute to their communities and workplaces. The major prepares students to work effectively with employers, colleagues, and clients by developing their ability to think critically, understand diverse perspectives, question assumptions, conduct thorough research, think creatively, and communicate effectively.

Student Learning Outcomes

Through student-driven discussions, based on engagement with critical and cultural texts by gender scholars, activists, and professionals, the Women's and Gender Studies Program curriculum will help students develop the necessary skills to:

- Increase awareness of women's history and experiences that affect representations of gender in contemporary society.
- Explore forms of social inequality through feminist theories and concepts.
- Understand how intersecting identities shape individuals and their life experiences.
- Analyze gender dynamics in different types of relationships.

Degree Requirements

Women's and Gender Studies (B.A., B.S.)

An undergraduate major requires a minimum 2.00 GPA in the 33 credits of core and cross-listed courses. Women's and Gender Studies majors must satisfy the following requirements:

1. 15 credits of Women's and Gender Studies core courses.

Required Core Courses:

WGS 2010	Introduction to Women's and Gender Studies	3
WGS 3010	International Perspectives on Women and Gender	3
WGS 4010	Feminist Theories	3
WGS 4020	Feminist Research in Action	3
Women's and Gender Studies Choice 4000 Level		3
Total Credits		15

2. The remaining 18 credits of required coursework can be chosen from any of the courses below.

WGS Program-Offered Courses:

WGS 2030	Introduction to Lesbian Communities	3
WGS 2050	Introduction to Queer Studies	3
WGS 2100	Gender and Sexuality in American Pop Culture	3
WGS 3250	Portrayals of Gender and Sexualities in the Media	3
WGS 3500	Women of Color in the U.S (Cross-listed as AFAM 3500)	3
WGS 4100	Human Trafficking (Cross-listed as SOC 4100)	3
WGS 4250	Intersections of Race, Class and Gender	3
WGS 4300	Gender and Consumer Culture	3
WGS 4400	Gender Issues in Sports	3
WGS 4500	Topics in Women's and Gender Studies	3
WGS 4900	Independent Study	1-3
WGS 4910	Internship	1-3
WGS 4990	Senior Thesis	3

WGS Courses Offered Across Disciplines:

Apparel, Events, and Hospitality Management:

WGS 4580	Queer Fashions: History, Culture, and the Industry (Cross-listed FDM 4580)	3
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Art and visual culture:

WGS 4940	Women/Gender in Art (Cross-listed as ARTH 4940)	3
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Biology:

WGS 3070	Women in Science and Engineering (Cross-listed as BIOL 3070)	3
WGS 3440	Human Reproduction (Cross-listed as BIOL 3440)	3

English:

WGS 3080	Writing Women's Lives (Cross-listed as ENGL 3080)	3
WGS 3230	Gender and Communication (Cross-listed as SPCM 3230)	3
WGS 3450	Women's Literature (Cross-listed as ENGL 3450)	3
WGS 3520	Queer Literature (Cross-listed as ENGL 3520)	3
WGS 4220	Language and Gender (Cross-listed as LING 4220 and ENGL 4220)	3
WGS 4600	Seminar in Gender and Ethnicity (Cross-listed as ENGL 4600)	3

Economics:

WGS 3210	Economics of Discrimination (Cross-listed as ECON 3210)	3
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History:

WGS 3800	History of Women in Science, Technology, and Medicine (Cross-listed as HIST 3800)	3
WGS 3860	History of Women in America (Cross-listed as HIST 3860)	3
WGS 4570	History of American Sexualities (Cross-listed as HIST 4570)	3

Leadership Studies:

WGS 3330	Women, Gender, and Leadership (Cross-listed as LDST 3330)	3
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Philosophy & religion:

WGS 3360	Religion, Sex and Gender (Cross-listed as RELIG 3360)	3
WGS 3380	Feminist Philosophy (Cross-listed as PHIL 3380)	3
WGS 3390	Goddess Religions (Cross-listed as RELIG 3390)	3

Political science:

WGS 3850	Women in Politics (Cross-listed as POLS 3850)	3
WGS 3870	First Ladies in U.S. History (Cross-listed as POLS 3870 and HIST 3870)	3

Psychology:

WGS 3460	Psychology of Women (Cross-listed as PSYCH 3460)	3
WGS 3490X	Psychology of Sexual Orientation (Cross-listed as PSYCH 3490X)	3

Sociology:

WGS 3270	Gender and Sexualities in Society (Cross-listed as SOC 3270)	3
WGS 3280	Sociology of Masculinities and Manhood (Cross-listed as SOC 3280)	3

World Languages & Cultures:

WGS 3700F	Studies in English Translation: French Topics on Women and Gender Studies (Cross-listed as FRNCH 3700F)	3
WGS 3700R	Studies in English Translation: Russian Topics on Women or Feminism (Cross-listed as RUS 3700R)	3
WGS 3700S	Studies in English Translation: Hispanic Topics on Women or Feminism (Cross-listed as SPAN 3700S)	3
WGS 3740	Sex, Gender, and Culture in the Ancient Mediterranean World (Cross-listed as HIST 3740 and CLST 3740)	3

A minor or additional major is recommended. The typical degree awarded is a Bachelor of Arts; students interested in a Bachelor of Science degree in Women's and Gender Studies need to complete 12 credits in addition to the general education requirements across the areas of natural science, mathematics, and social science.

Communication Proficiency requirement:

The Women's and Gender Studies major requires credit for ENGL 1500; ENGL 2500 (or ENGL 2500H) (with a grade of C or better, per the university-wide Communication Proficiency Grade Requirement (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#communicationproficiencypolicytext>)); and WGS 3010 or WGS 4010 or WGS 4020 (with a grade of C or better).

Students in all ISU majors must complete a three-credit course in U.S. Cultures and Communities (<https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/us-cultures-and-communities-courses/>) and a three-credit course in International Perspectives (<https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/international-perspectives-courses/>). Discuss with your advisor how the two courses that you select can be applied to your graduation plan.

LAS majors require a minimum of 120 credits, **including a minimum of 45 credits at the 3000/4000 level**. You must also complete the LAS General Education requirements as well as the world language and career proficiency requirements. Explore these links

for more details about all College of Liberal Arts and Sciences (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofliberalartsandsciences/#lascollegerequirementstext>) and University-wide requirements (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegescurricula/>) students complete for graduation in addition to those stated above for the major.

Four Year Plan

Women's and Gender Studies, B.A., B.S. (1)

Freshman

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500	3 WGS 2010	3
LIB 1600	1 Math Choice	3
World Language/Elective ¹	3-4 World Language/Elective	3-4
Humanities Choice	3 Humanities Choice	3
Natural Science Choice	3 Social Science Choice	3
Social Science Choice	3	
16-17		15-16

Sophomore

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
WGS 3010	3 Women's and Gender Studies Choices - 2000/3000 Level	3
Women's and Gender Studies Choices - 2000/3000 Level	3 Int'l Perspectives Choice	3
Humanities Choice	3 US Cultures and Communities Choice	3
ENGL 2500	3 Humanities Choice	3
Natural Science Choice	3 Social Science Choice	3
	LAS 2030	1
15		16

Junior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
Women's and Gender Studies Choice - 3000/4000 Level	3 WGS 4020	3
Electives	7 Women's and Gender Studies Choice - 3000/4000 Level	3
Natural Science Choice	2 Electives - 3000/4000 Level	9
WGS 4010	3	
15		15

Senior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
Women's and Gender Studies Choice - 3000/4000 Level	6 Women's and Gender Studies Choice - 3000/4000 Level	3
Women's and Gender Studies Choice - 4000 Level	3 Electives - 3000/4000 Level	6
Elective - 3000/4000 Level	6 Electives	5
15		14

Total Credits: 121-123

Minor

Undergraduate students may minor in Women's and Gender Studies by taking 15 semester hours of Women's and Gender Studies classes, including the following:

WGS 2010	Introduction to Women's and Gender Studies	3
WGS 3010	International Perspectives on Women and Gender	3

One 4000-level WGS course and 6 additional credits in WGS; at least 3 of the additional credits must be at the 3000-4000 level.

University policy requires that at least 3 credits used for the minor stand alone and are not used to meet any other requirement. All WGS courses for the minor require a grade of C (not C-) or higher.

Any student can declare a major or minor in Women's and Gender Studies or choose to co-major in another program. Students interested in a minor or major in Women's and Gender Studies should contact the director or the undergraduate advisor in the program.

The Women's and Gender Studies Undergraduate Minor is an LAS Minor. In addition to University policies governing minors, LAS minors require at least 6 credits in courses numbered 3000 and above, with a grade of C or higher.

Graduate Study

The graduate minor in Women's and Gender Studies is designed to provide students with knowledge of theories and methods within a variety of approaches in feminist scholarship. The program seeks to integrate and synthesize knowledge from many disciplines and to offer students opportunities for systematic study of gender and women's experiences and perspectives in all knowledge fields. Students will be prepared to take a leadership role in supporting gender equity and diversity in their careers in education, social service work, business, law, public policy, governmental and non-governmental organizations, and research.

The graduate minor requires 9 credits for students enrolled in a master's or a doctoral degree program. Students are required to take either WGS 5010 Contemporary Feminist Theories or WGS 5020 Advanced

Seminar in Feminist Research Methods; taking both is strongly recommended. Students will also take one or two electives selected from the list of core and cross-listed Women's and Gender Studies courses approved for graduate study. At least one member of the faculty affiliated with Women's and Gender Studies will serve on the program of study for doctoral students. A list of eligible faculty members may be obtained from the Director of the Women's and Gender Studies Program.

Required - choose at least one:

WGS 5010	Contemporary Feminist Theories	3
WGS 5020	Advanced Seminar in Feminist Research Methods	3

WGS Graduate Courses:

WGS 5100	Human Trafficking (Cross-listed as SOC 5100)	3
WGS 5250	Intersections of Race, Class and Gender	3
WGS 5350	Gender, Globalization and Development	3
WGS 5450	Women's Literature (Cross-listed as ENGL 5450)	3
WGS 5580	Queer Fashions: History, Culture, and the Industry (Cross-listed as AMD 5580)	3
WGS 5860	Readings Seminar in Women's and Gender History (Cross-listed as HIST 5860))	3
WGS 5900	Special Topics	1-30
WGS 5940	Women/Gender in Art (Cross-listed as ARTH 5940)	3
WGS 6210	Pedagogies of Dissent (Cross-listed as ELSP 6210)	3